

Apply — spot a disruption

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~25 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You have completed the previous 5 handouts
- ☐ You are signed in to the platform and inside your country project
- ☐ You are on the **Visualizations** tab

WHY IT MATTERS

The first five handouts taught the technique. This is where you use it: open a real disruption chart for your country, work the six-step framework on it, and produce a finding statement that a decision-maker would actually act on.

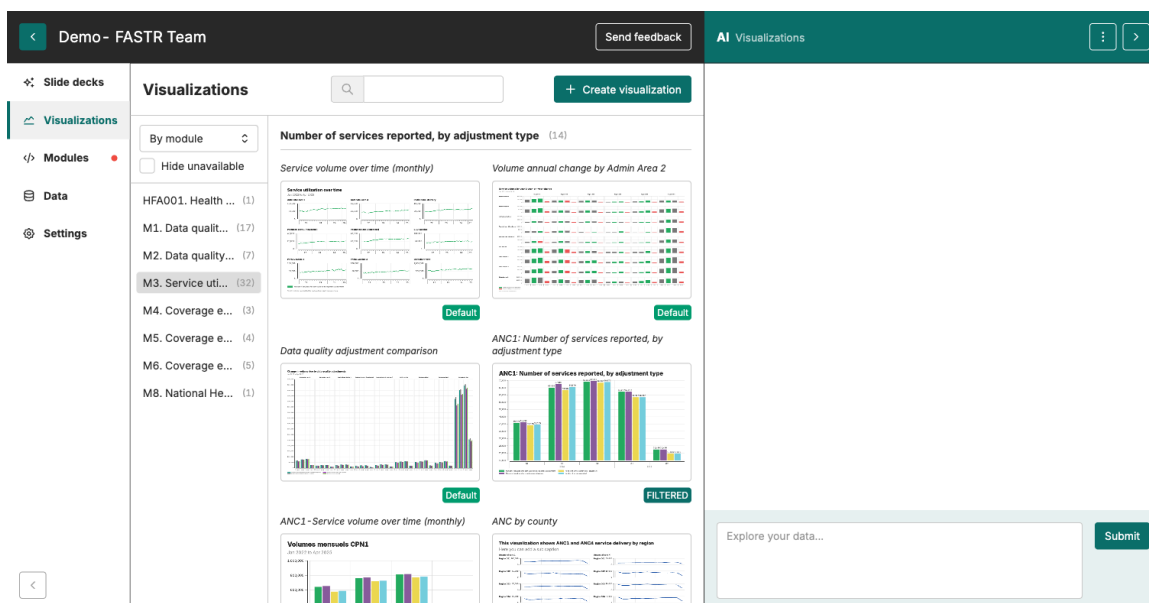
What you'll do

Open the Disruptions and surpluses (national) chart, narrow it to one indicator and a time window of interest, work through the six-step framework, then write a three-part finding to share with the room.

1 Find the disruption chart

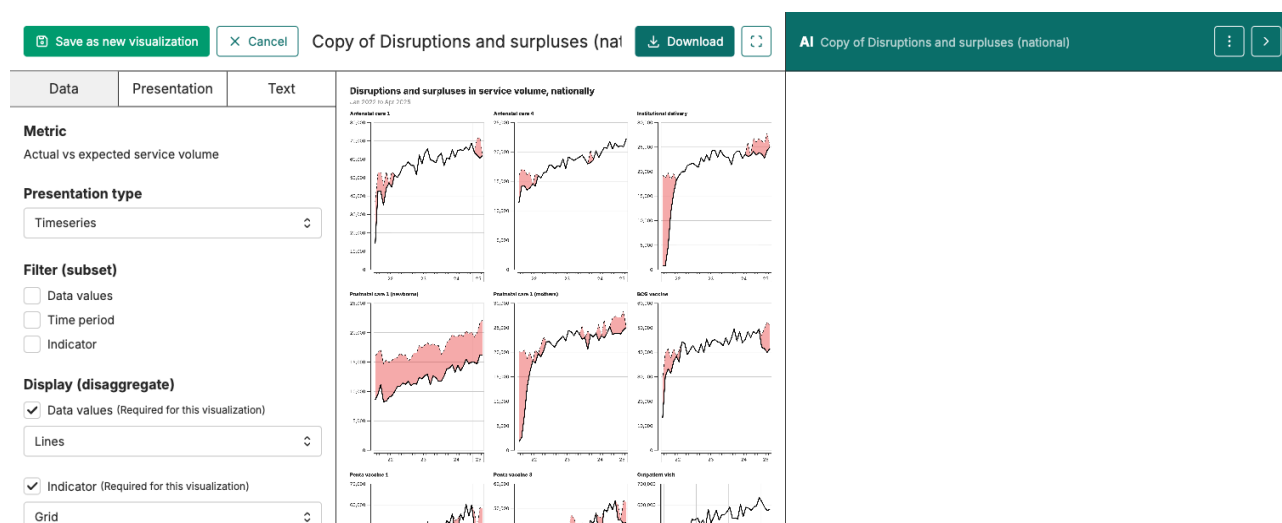
In the **Visualizations** tab, switch the view toggle (top left of the visualization list) to **By module**. This groups the visualizations by which module produced them.

Open **M3. Service utilization**. Scroll until you see the group titled **Actual vs expected service volume — National**. The first card in that group is **Disruptions and surpluses (national)**. Click it to open.



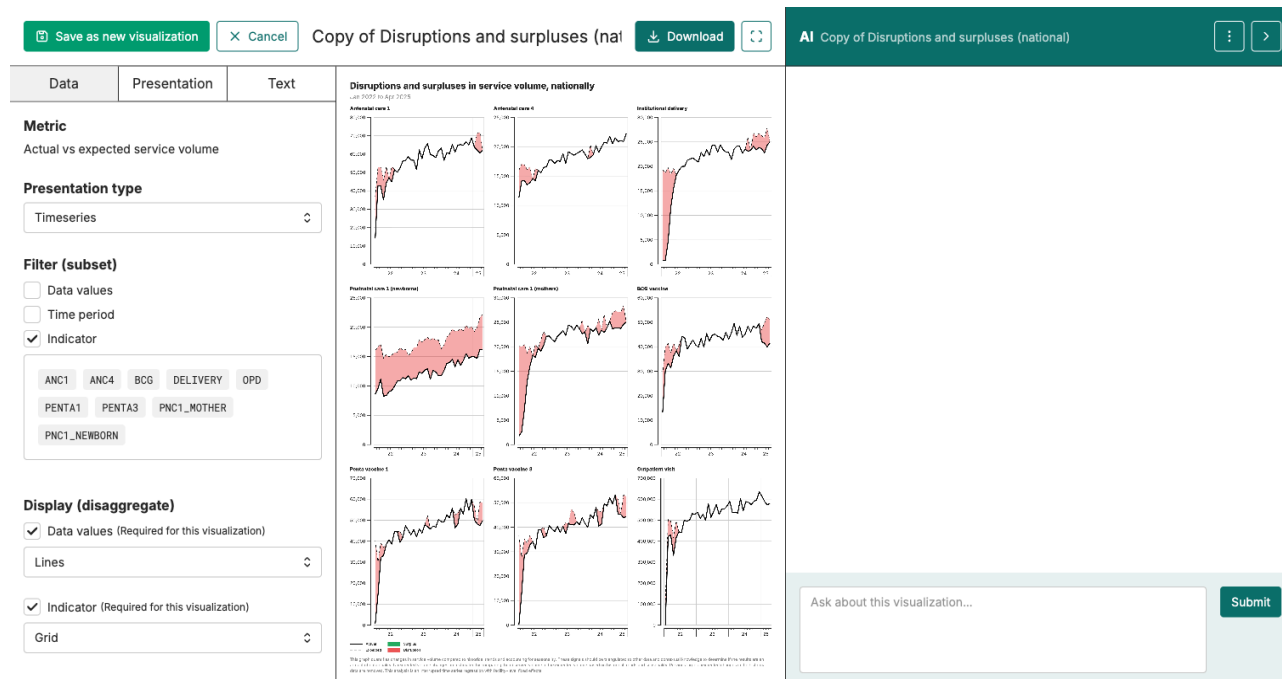
2 Read the default view

The default chart shows every core indicator as a small chart in a grid. Two black lines run across each chart: a **solid** line for **actual** monthly service volume, and a **dashed** line for the **expected** volume predicted from past trends. The area between them is filled — **red** where actual sits **below** expected (a disruption), **green** where actual sits **above** expected (a surplus).

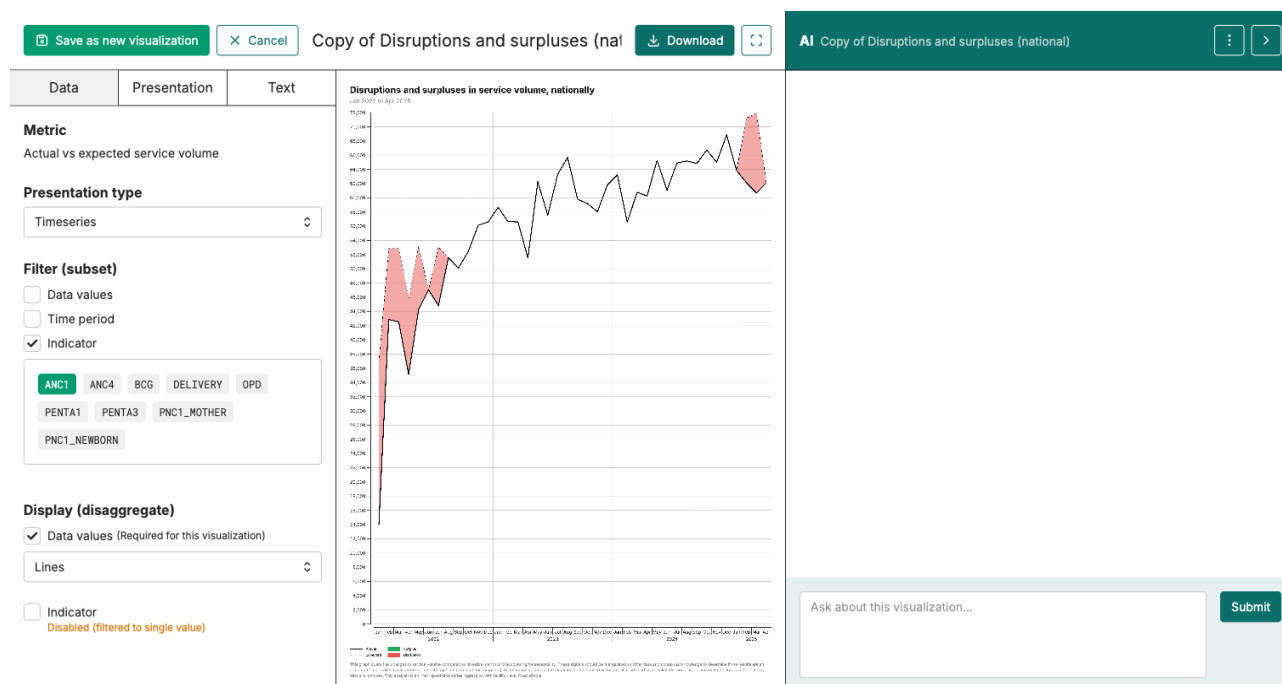


3 Filter to one indicator

In the **Data** tab on the left, find the **Filter (subset)** section and tick the **Indicator** checkbox. A list of indicator chips appears (ANC1, ANC4, BCG, DELIVERY, OPD, PENTA1, PENTA3, PNC1_MOTHER, PNC1_NEWBORN). Click one chip to filter the chart to that indicator. Click more chips to add others.



When a single indicator is selected, the grid collapses to a single full-size chart. You can also tick **Time period** to narrow the window further.



4 Work the six steps

On your filtered chart, walk the six-step framework from *Reading a viz*.

Step	For this chart
1. What indicator?	The one you filtered to
2. What level & period?	National. The period you chose.
3. What is being compared?	Actual monthly volume (solid black line) vs expected (dashed black line, predicted from past trends)
4. Read the values	Where does the gap fill red (actual below expected)? By how much?
5. What stands out?	A sustained drop, three months or more? A single spike? A pattern?
6. So what?	What action would this prompt?

5 Add context the chart cannot show

The chart shows the *what*. Your country team brings the *why*. Once you have a pattern, layer in what you know:

- Was there a **financing or staffing change** in that period?
- Are there known **supply or workforce gaps** (drugs, equipment, staffing)?
- Even if the **numbers look fine**, has the quality of care slipped?

6 Write your finding

Use the three-part structure from the *Write an interpretation* handout:

1. **Title** — the message in one sentence
2. **What you see** — facts visible in the chart
3. **What it means** — the so-what, tied to a concrete next step

7 Share with the room

When each country team is done, one person shares the finding. Listen for:

- Is the finding **specific**? One indicator, one period, one action.
- Is the so-what **tied to a real decision-maker**?
- Did the team **bring local context** the chart alone could not?

What to watch out for

- **A one-month dip is usually noise.** Look for a sustained drop, three months or more.
- **A green fill is not "good", a red fill is not "bad".** They just show direction: green = actual above expected, red = actual below expected. A small red fill for one month is normal noise; a sustained red over several months is what to investigate.

What's next

This is the end of the *Visualizations & Interpretation* series. The next module covers building reports — putting your charts, interpretations, and findings into a shareable document.